the daily situation reports. Often, the MO Dte would be so embroiled in the day-to-day operations, that it would lose sight of the bigger picture.

The other major change was to bring the functions of Capability Development and Sustenance under one DCOAS, by shuffling of responsibilities. Thus DCOAS (P&S) was rechristened as DCOAS (CD&S). This became a very important appointment as all new capital acquisitions from the capital budget, as well as all maintenance and operation requirements from the revenue budget, were now being coordinated by one person. The MGO became the MGS, reporting to the DCOAS (CD&S). There were other changes too, including the optimization of the MT Dte and the merger of its balance elements with the ARTRAC. There was also a thought of merging all the HR functions under one vertical, officers being dealt with by the MS Branch and JCOs/OR being dealt with by the AGs Branch, but that was discarded early on, being impractical. It was also felt that at the level of the Army HQ, value addition could better be done by officers with sufficient seniority and experience, and thus a number of appointments at the Grade 1 (Lt Col) and Grade 2 (Maj) level were reduced, with the aim that these relatively junior officers would then be available for posting to units, who were facing officer shortages as it is. For greater transparency and probity, two additional appointments were created, an ADG (Vigilance) to report directly to the COAS and an ADG (Human Rights) reporting to the VCOAS. These deliberations within the Army HQ continued and it was not until the first half of 2019 that the proposal was first sent to the Ministry for the in-principle approval of the RM, which was granted in July 2019.[22]

The proposal had now to run the bureaucratic gauntlet for the issue of a formal GSL. With the appointment of Gen Rawat

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